

The main code

The main part of the code is a loop that gets a letter from the player and checks if it's in the secret word. If it is, the code uses a function to update the clue. You'll make that function, then create the main loop.

► How it works

The function contains a **while** loop that works through the secret word one letter at a time, checking whether each letter matches the guessed letter. The **index** variable keeps count of the current letter as the program scans through the word.

If a letter matches, the program inserts it into the clue, using **index** to find the right position in the list of question marks.

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Is the letter in the secret word?

If the guessed letter is in the secret word, you must update the clue. To do this, you'll use a function called **update_clue()**. The function has three parameters: the letter being guessed, the secret word, and the clue. Add this code after the **guessed_word_correctly** variable.

```
guessed_word_correctly = False
```

```
def update_clue(guessed_letter, secret_word, clue):
```

```
    index = 0
```

```
    while index < len(secret_word):
```

```
        if guessed_letter == secret_word[index]:
```

```
            clue[index] = guessed_letter
```

```
            index = index + 1
```

len() returns how many letters are in a word – in this case five.

Add 1 to the index value.

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Guess a letter or word

Your program should keep asking the user to guess a letter or the whole word until they either get the correct answer or run out of lives. This is what the main loop does. Add this code below the **update_clue()** function.

This shows the clue and how many lives the player has left.

If the guessed letter is in the secret word, the clue is updated.

If the guess is incorrect (**else**), the number of lives is reduced by 1.

```
    index = index + 1
```

```
while lives > 0:
```

```
    print(clue)
```

```
    print('Lives left: ' + heart_symbol * lives)
```

```
    guess = input('Guess a letter or the whole word: ')
```

```
    if guess == secret_word:
```

```
        guessed_word_correctly = True
```

```
        break
```

```
    if guess in secret_word:
```

```
        update_clue(guess, secret_word, clue)
```

```
    else:
```

```
        print('Incorrect. You lose a life')
```

```
        lives = lives - 1
```

The loop keeps running while there are lives left.

This gets the guessed letter or word from the player.

When the word is guessed correctly, this line breaks the loop.